

2026 GLOBAL QUANTUM + AI CHALLENGE

Participant Terms & Conditions

Organized by Resonance Alliance Inc.

By applying to the 2026 Global Quantum + AI Challenge (the “Challenge”), you (“Participant”) agree to be bound by these Terms & Conditions. The Challenge is organized and administered by Resonance Alliance Inc., operating as The Quantum Insider (“Resonance”, “we”, or “us”).

1. The Challenge

The 2026 Global Quantum + AI Challenge is a curated, international innovation program designed to accelerate practical, enterprise-relevant quantum and quantum-AI use cases. The Challenge is structured in two phases:

- Phase 1 (Ideation): Teams submit concept proposals responding to published enterprise problem statements.
- Phase 2 (PoC Sprint): A selected finalist cohort builds proof-of-concept-grade demonstrators with access to compute resources, tooling, and expert support.

Resonance reserves the right to modify the Challenge structure, timeline, phases, or format at any time, and will communicate material changes to registered Participants.

2. Eligibility

The Challenge is open to startups, research teams, universities, and industry teams worldwide. To participate, you must:

- Be at least 18 years of age (or the age of majority in your jurisdiction).
- Have the legal authority to enter into these Terms on behalf of yourself or your team/organization.
- Not be subject to any applicable sanctions, export controls, or trade restrictions that would prevent participation.

Employees and Contractors of Resonance or its Challenge enterprise sponsors may not submit proposals as Participants. Resonance reserves the right to verify eligibility and disqualify any Participant at its sole discretion.

3. Submissions

All submissions must be original work and must not infringe on any third-party intellectual property rights. By submitting a proposal, you represent and warrant that:

- You have the right to submit the materials provided.
- Your submission does not contain any confidential or proprietary information of any third party disclosed without permission.
- Your submission complies with all applicable laws and regulations.

Resonance may, at its discretion, reject or disqualify any submission that is incomplete, late, or does not conform to published submission guidelines.

4. Intellectual Property

This section sets out how intellectual property is treated across the Challenge. The intent is to protect Participant innovation while enabling the program to operate effectively.

4.1 Participant IP

All intellectual property contained in your submission remains your property. Nothing in these Terms transfers ownership of your pre-existing IP or IP created as part of your submission to Resonance or to any Challenge sponsor. You retain full rights to develop, commercialize, license, or otherwise exploit your work.

4.2 License to Resonance

By submitting a proposal, you grant Resonance a non-exclusive, royalty-free, worldwide license to:

- Reproduce, display, and distribute your submission materials solely for the purposes of Challenge administration, evaluation, and judging.
- Reference your team name, submission title, and a summary description in Challenge-related communications, marketing, press materials, and reports.

This license does not extend to the commercial exploitation of your underlying technology or IP.

Resonance will not share the full content of your submission with third parties outside the evaluation and judging process without your prior written consent, unless it is already publicly available (for example as part of an ArXiv paper).

Resonance may publicly disclose the organizational affiliations of applicants (for example, the university, company, or institution with which a team is associated) for the purposes of Challenge promotion and reporting. Personal names of individual team members will not be disclosed without your prior written consent.

4.3 Sponsor Access

Challenge enterprise sponsors will have access to submissions for the purposes of evaluation, internal innovation assessment, and jury participation. Sponsors do not acquire any ownership rights over Participant submissions by virtue of their sponsorship or access. Any access is granted on a non-exclusive, review-only basis.

4.4 Post-Challenge Engagement

Any engagement between a Participant and a sponsor following the Challenge (including but not limited to proof-of-concept collaborations, licensing, joint development, or commercial agreements) will be governed exclusively by a separate, bilateral agreement negotiated directly between the relevant parties. Resonance is not a party to any such agreement unless expressly included.

4.5 Resonance Program IP

Resonance retains all right, title, and interest in the Challenge program structure, operating model, digital platforms, submission portal, evaluation frameworks, data schemas, templates, branding, and methodologies, whether developed before or during the Challenge.

5. Evaluation and Judging

Submissions will be evaluated by a review panel comprising representatives from Challenge sponsors, technical experts, and reviewers selected by Resonance in consultation with Challenge Sponsors. Phase 2 finalists will present to a jury comprising senior leaders from industry, academia, and the investment community. Evaluation criteria will be published on the Challenge website and may include technical merit, feasibility, innovation, potential impact, and clarity of presentation. All decisions are final. Resonance reserves the right to adjust evaluation criteria or review panel and jury composition as needed.

6. Prizes and Awards

Details of any prizes, awards, or recognition associated with the Challenge will be published on the Challenge website and in email communications to participants. Resonance reserves the right to modify prize structures at any time. Prizes may be subject to applicable taxes, which are the sole responsibility of the recipient. Where a prize is awarded to a team, the team lead will be responsible for distribution among team members.

7. Confidentiality

If you are selected as a finalist and are given access to sponsor problem statements, technical briefings, compute resources, or other non-public materials, you agree to treat such information as confidential and not disclose it to any third party without prior written consent from the disclosing party. Resonance will treat the technical content of your submissions as confidential within the evaluation process, subject to the license granted in Section 4.2.

8. Data and Privacy

Resonance will collect and process personal data provided during registration and participation in accordance with applicable data protection laws. Your data will be used for Challenge administration, communications, and evaluation. We may share your name, team affiliation, and submission summary with Challenge sponsors and partners for program-related purposes. By participating, you consent to receiving Challenge-related communications from Resonance.

We may share your name, team affiliation, and submission summary with Challenge sponsors and partners for program-related purposes. For Phase 2 finalists, Resonance may publicly disclose the composition of finalist teams, including individual names, team size, and organizational affiliations, for the purposes of announcing results, press coverage, and Challenge reporting. By accepting an invitation to Phase 2, you consent to this disclosure.

9. Disclaimers and Limitation of Liability

The Challenge is provided “as is”. To the maximum extent permitted by law, Resonance makes no warranties, express or implied, regarding the Challenge, including any compute resources, tools, or platforms made available. Resonance shall not be liable for any indirect, incidental, consequential, or special damages arising from your participation. Resonance’s total aggregate liability in connection with the Challenge shall not exceed the value of any prize awarded to you.

10. Code of Conduct

Participants are expected to engage professionally and respectfully throughout the Challenge. Resonance reserves the right to disqualify any Participant or team whose conduct is, in Resonance's sole judgment, disruptive, unethical, or harmful to other Participants, sponsors, or the integrity of the Challenge.

11. Modification and Cancellation

Resonance reserves the right to modify, suspend, or cancel the Challenge at any time for any reason, including circumstances beyond its reasonable control. In such an event, Resonance will use reasonable efforts to notify registered Participants.

12. Governing Law

These Terms shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Province of Ontario, Canada, without regard to conflict of law principles. Any disputes shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts of Ontario, Canada.

13. Contact

For questions about these Terms or the Challenge, please use the online portal or email hello@resonance.holdings.